

Board 1

South Deals

None Vul

♠ -

♥ 10 9 6 3

♦ K Q J 9 4

♣ Q 10 9 7

♠ K Q 9 8 7 5 2

♥ A 2

♦ A 2

♣ 5 2



♠ 10 3

♥ K Q J 8 4

♦ 10 8 7 5

♣ J 8

♠ A J 6 4

♥ 7 5

♦ 6 3

♣ A K 6 4 3

West

North

East

South

Pass

1♠

Pass

1♣

Pass

4NT

Pass

2♠

Pass

6♠

5♥

All Pass

6♠ by North

North is to play 6♠. East leads the ♥K.

Losers: ♠=0 ♥=1 ♦=1 ♣=0 Total = 2

One of the two red losers must be discarded on dummy's ♣ suit. So you pull trumps, taking two rounds, with ♠K and ♠Q. Then play two top ♣s and ruff a ♣. When East shows out on the third ♣, enter dummy with a trump and ruff another ♣. Dummy's final ♣ is now established, so enter dummy with another trump and discard one of the red losers on the fifth ♣.

As long as the ♣s were no worse than 4-2 you can establish the suit.

Board 3

South Deals

None Vul

♠ K 6 4 3

♥ 9 7

♦ K 10 8 6 2

♣ 8 2

♠ 10 9 7 2

♥ A J 6

♦ 7 5

♣ Q 6 4 3

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ A 8

♥ Q 10 8 2

♦ Q J 9

♣ J 10 9 7

♠ Q J 5

♥ K 5 4 3

♦ A 4 3

♣ A K 5

West

North

East

South

1NT

All Pass

1NT by South

No, you must establish ♠s, the suit where they have 2 winners anyway. So you play a ♠ which West wins. He takes his 2 ♦s but you are now home free. When you gain the lead again you will get your ♠ winner established and only lose 2 ♠s and 4 ♦s.

If you finessed the ♥ you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♥ and 2 ♠s.

If you had played 3 rounds of ♣s you would have gone down with the defenders winning 4 ♦s, 1 ♣ and 2 ♠s.

Only by establishing ♠s can you make the contract.

South is to play 1NT. West leads the ♦6, taken by East with the ♦J. East next plays the ♦Q on which West plays the ♦2. East plays the ♦9 which you finally win.

Winners: ♠=0 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 6

You only need one more winner and you have several possibilities. The ♥ finesse might work, or the ♣s might split 3-3. But you need to consider the defenders winners also. They have already scored 2 ♦ tricks and will get 2 more as soon as they gain the lead. (The spot cards told you that West has a 5-card ♦ suit.) Plus they have the 2 top ♠s which they can take whenever they like. So if your play sets up just one more trick for them you will go down.

Board 5

North Deals

N-S Vul

♠ A 4
 ♥ J 10 4
 ♦ Q J 10 6
 ♣ J 7 5 4

♠ K J 7

♥ A K 7 5

♦ A 8 7 3

♣ K Q

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ 9 8 6 5 3

♥ Q 9 3 2

♦ K 4

♣ 6 2

♠ Q 10 2

♥ 8 6

♦ 9 5 2

♣ A 10 9 8 3

West

North

East

South

2NT

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

North is to play 3NT. East leads the ♠9, taken by West with the ♠A. West next plays the ♠4.

Winners: ♠=2 ♥=2 ♦=1 ♣=3 Total = 8

You only need one more winner and if ♦s split 3-3 you can easily establish a trick in that suit. But what if ♦s split 4-2? If the ♣J falls you can get an extra ♣ trick. In fact, no matter how the ♣s are arranged you can establish your extra trick there.

First make sure that you win the second trick with the ♠K, keeping dummy's ♠Q for a later entry. Then play ♣K, and ♣Q overtaking with dummy's ♣A. Then play the ♣10, losing to the ♣J but establishing the ♣9 while you still have the ♠Q as an entry.

As you see, you couldn't set up a ♦ trick so the ♣ overtake was necessary to make the contract.